DELIVERING YOUR SPEECH

I've prepared the best speech ever, what now?



Introduction:

At this point in the lecture series, we've covered the important elements of preparing a great speech: from audience analysis, to researching the topic, outlining and organising your points, as well as finessing your introduction and conclusion.

All that is left now is to get up and deliver your speech. Interestingly, people find the speech delivery to be harder or more scary than the preparation, even though it is the shortest part of the process.

This week, we will discuss all you need to for a fantastic delivery.

Methods of speech delivery

1. **Impromptu speaking:**

Impromptu speaking is the presentation of a short message without advance preparation. You have probably done impromptu speaking many times in informal, conversational settings; Often ceremonial toasts, grace before meals, an acknowledgement, an introduction, offering thanks and so on, fall into this category.

The advantage of this kind of speaking is that it's spontaneous and responsive.

The disadvantage is that the speaker is given little or no time to plan and organise his speech. As a result, the message may be disorganized and difficult for listeners to follow

2. **Manuscript speaking:**

The speech is written and the speaker reads it word for word to the audience. An example of this is newscasting where newscasters and television personalities read the script directly from notes.

It is used in situations where precision is important, the facts and names must be exact and accurate so there is no room for error.

However, even when using the manuscript delivery method, the speaker is still expected to maintain a conversational tone.

Methods of speech delivery

3. **Extemporaneous Style**:

For this style, the speech is not completely written out. It is usually delivered with keynotes for reference.

By using notes rather than a reading from a script, the speaker can establish and maintain eye contact with the audience and assess how well they are understanding the speech as it progresses.

This method presents you as knowledgeable since you are not reading directly from your notes. Also, it engages the audience verbally and non-verbally. This method also encourages flexibility.

The extemporaneous style is the method most often recommended and is generally the best method in other settings as well

4. **Memorized speaking:**

A.K.A la cram, la pour…this style refers to when the speech is memorised and recited word for word. In this case, the speech is a recitation.

This is mostly used by actors in delivering their lines, and by competitive debate teams.

You might use this method if your speech is quite short, or you will be required to repeat the speech multiple times.

The advantage to memorization is that it enables the speaker to maintain eye contact with the audience throughout the speech.

However, using this method could lead to delivering a flat speech, one that is lacking in vocal inflections (raising or lowering your voice to make a point).

Different types of speaking situations and key considerations

Being prepared to deal with different speaking situations will help reduce anxiety you may have about giving a speech, so let's look at factors you need to keep in mind as you prepare for your speech

- Using a lectern (a stand):

Do not be tempted to stand behind the lectern or hold on to it. Instead, try to move to the side or front of it and only use it to rest your notes.

- Speaking outdoors:

You may not have access to a presentation or a lectern to keep your notes, and this should be taken into consideration.You may need to request for a microphone beforehand, or project your voice over the space.

- Using a microphone:

You will need to speak clearly, because a microphone will amplify everything you say. Sometimes, you might be given a microphone when you do not need one (e.g. in a small space/audience), you can decline it if you do not need it, but speak clearly.

Practicing your delivery

There is no fool proof recipe for good delivery. Each of us is unique, and we each embody different experiences and interests. This means each person has an approach, or a style, that is effective for her or him.

But there are some techniques you can use to minimize that anxious feeling and put yourself in the best possible position to succeed on speech day.

Most importantly, **practice your speech beforehand, at home or elsewhere, the way you will give it in class.** This means:

- Practice your speech out loud
- Practice your speech standing up
- Practice with an audience
- Check the time while practicing
- You can practice by recording yourself

What do I do with …myself?

Your speech needs a balance of verbal and non-verbal components to bring your message to life. Therefore, it is best that you neither overdramatize your speech delivery behaviours nor downplay them. You don't want to overdo your delivery because it may distract your audience, at the same time, you should not downplay it because then you don't look natural.

- Hands: The key for knowing what to do with your hands is to use them naturally as you would in normal conversation. Try to pay attention to what you do with your hands in regular conversations and incorporate that into your delivery.
- Feet: The default position for your feet is to have them shoulder-width apart in a natural stance. It is fine to adjust your weight or move out from behind the lectern, but constant motion (or perpetual stillness) will not lead to good overall delivery.

What do I do with … my stuff?

- Objects: There is a very simple rule when it comes to what you should carry when you give your speech: Only take what you absolutely need to give the speech. These would be your notes, materials and any visual aids. There is no need to take your cell phone, tab or laptop with you if you are not using them for your notes. **Cell phones are not usually large enough to serve as presentation notes; we've seen students squint and hold the phone up to their faces**
- Also be careful with your choice of dressing; do not wear jewellery that jingles when you move and make sure you are wearing comfortable shoes.



A FINAL THOUGHT ON PRACTICE. WE HAVE ALL HEARD, “PRACTICE MAKES PERFECT.” THAT IS NOT ALWAYS TRUE. PRACTICE MAKES PERMANENT; THE ACTIONS BECOME HABITUAL. IF YOU PRACTICE INCORRECTLY, YOUR PERFORMANCE WILL BE INCORRECT. BE SURE YOUR PRACTICE IS CORRECT